



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*prāsāda+sopāna+tala+praṇāдай |
kāñcī+ravair* nūpura+nisvanaiś* ca |
(vitṛāsayantyo* Cvibhrāmayantyo*)grha+pakṣi+saṃghān |
anyo+anya+vegāṃś* ca samākṣipantyaḥ | |3.15|*

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Imagine the palace as a microcosm of your own mind, teeming with thoughts and emotions. This verse from the Buddhacarita paints a vivid scene: the sounds of palatial stairways echoing with footsteps, the tinkling of waistbands, and the jingling of anklets. These sounds, amplified by the bustle of palace life, startle the flocks of birds dwelling within the palace walls, sending them into a flurry of motion. The women, caught up in their activities, inadvertently accelerate each other's pace, creating a whirlwind of activity.

This seemingly simple description holds a deeper spiritual significance. The palace represents the human consciousness, and the various sounds symbolize the constant stream of thoughts, desires, and sensory experiences that fill our minds. The birds, easily startled, represent our own fleeting attention, constantly drawn to the next stimulus. The women, caught in a cycle of activity, mirror our tendency to become entangled in the endless pursuit of worldly pleasures and distractions.

Just as the palace birds are agitated by the sounds, our minds are often overwhelmed by the incessant chatter of thoughts and emotions. We become reactive, like the women in the palace, swept away by the momentum of external events. We lose sight of our inner peace and become trapped in a cycle of reactivity.

The lesson here is clear: to find true peace and liberation, you must learn to quiet the inner noise and cultivate mindfulness. Just as the Buddha sought refuge from the distractions of palace life, you too must find a quiet space within yourself, a space where you can observe your thoughts and emotions without being carried away by them. By cultivating awareness, you can break free from the cycle of reactivity and find lasting peace and freedom. Don't let the constant noise of the world, or your own mind, distract you from your path to enlightenment.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you create more space for stillness in your daily life, allowing you to observe your thoughts and emotions with greater clarity and detachment?